PADHAKU
Contemporary India · Class 10 Social Science



CHAPTER 2

Forest and Wildlife Resources

NCERT Exercise Solutions

Activity · Flora and Fauna in India	1 Q
Activity · Conservation of Forest and Wildlife in India	2 Q
Activity · Community and Conservation	1 Q
Exercises	6 Q

✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡 answers are samples: write your own.

Independent study aid by Beginers Point. Not an official NCERT publication.

Activity · Flora and Fauna in India

Find out stories prevalent in your region which are about the harmonious relationship between human beings and nature.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Model answer (stories differ from region to region):

- **Bishnoi community, Rajasthan:** In 1730, Amrita Devi Bishnoi and over 360 Bishnois gave their lives at Khejarli village to stop the cutting of khejri trees. Even today, Bishnois protect blackbuck, nilgai and peacocks.
- **Chipko movement, Uttarakhand:** Village women hugged trees to stop them from being cut down.
- **Sacred groves:** In many villages, a patch of forest is kept for the local god or goddess, and nobody cuts trees there.
- **Worship of trees:** People worship peepal, banyan and tulsi and do not cut them.

These stories teach us that people and nature can live together and help each other.

Activity · Conservation of Forest and Wildlife in India

Collect more information on the wildlife sanctuaries and national parks of India and cite their locations on the map of India.

SAMPLE ANSWER

Model list to locate on the map of India:

Name	State
Corbett National Park	Uttarakhand
Sunderbans National Park	West Bengal
Bandhavgarh National Park	Madhya Pradesh
Kanha National Park	Madhya Pradesh
Sariska Wildlife Sanctuary (Tiger Reserve)	Rajasthan
Ranthambore National Park	Rajasthan
Manas Tiger Reserve	Assam
Kaziranga National Park	Assam
Periyar Tiger Reserve	Kerala
Gir National Park	Gujarat
Dachigam National Park	Jammu and Kashmir

Mark each one with a dot on an outline map of India and write its name next to it.

? **Look at the news clippings "Gharial on the brink" and "Bird deaths blamed on dirty Yamuna". Can you find out the reasons for the above mentioned problems?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Gharial on the brink – reasons:

- Pollution of rivers and loss of sandy river banks where gharials lay eggs (dams, sand mining).
- Gharials get caught and drown in fishing nets; fish (their food) is reduced by over-fishing.
- Less water in rivers in summer due to dams and too much use of river water.

Bird deaths in the Yamuna – reasons:

- Untreated sewage and industrial waste make the water dirty and toxic.
- Stagnant water has toxic elements; birds that drink the water or eat fish from it fall ill and die.

Both problems are caused by human activities that pollute and damage the habitat of wildlife. (check the picture in your book)

🧪 **Activity · Community and Conservation**

? **Write a short essay on any practices which you may have observed and practised in your**

everyday lives that conserve and protect the environment around you.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Small Steps to Protect Our Environment (model essay)

In my everyday life, I and my family follow some simple habits that help protect the environment.

- We switch off lights and fans when we leave a room, to save electricity.
- We close taps properly and reuse water, e.g. water used for washing vegetables is given to plants.
- We carry cloth bags to the market and avoid plastic bags.
- We separate wet and dry waste; kitchen waste is turned into compost for our plants.
- On birthdays and on Van Mahotsav we plant trees and look after them.
- We keep a bowl of water and grains for birds on the roof in summer.
- I walk or cycle to school, which causes no pollution.

These small habits, if followed by everyone, can save our forests, water and wildlife for the future.

Exercises

1 (i) **Which of the following conservation strategies do not directly involve community participation?**

(a) Joint forest management

(b) Beej Bachao Andolan

(c) Chipko Movement

(d) Demarcation of Wildlife sanctuaries

✔ ANSWER

(d) Demarcation of Wildlife sanctuaries

It is done by the government (Forest Department), while the other three involve local people directly.

2 **Match the following.**

Column A	Column B
Reserved forests	Other forests and wastelands belonging to both government and private individuals and communities.
Protected forests	Forests are regarded as most valuable as far as the conservation of forest and wildlife resources.
Unclassed forests	Forest lands are protected from any further depletion.

✔ ANSWER

Forest type	Matching description

Reserved forests	Forests are regarded as most valuable as far as the conservation of forest and wildlife resources.
Protected forests	Forest lands are protected from any further depletion.
Unclassed forests	Other forests and wastelands belonging to both government and private individuals and communities.

3 (i) What is biodiversity? Why is biodiversity important for human lives?

✔ ANSWER

Biodiversity is the variety of life on the earth – plants, animals and micro-organisms, wild and cultivated, diverse in form and function but linked to each other through a network of interdependencies.

Importance for human lives:

- Plants, animals and micro-organisms keep the air, water and soil clean and fertile – our life support systems.
- Forests are primary producers on which all other living beings, including humans, depend.
- It gives us food, medicines, wood and many other products; genetic diversity helps in better crops (traditional varieties) and fisheries.

3 (ii) **How have human activities affected the depletion of flora and fauna? Explain.**

✔ ANSWER

Human activities have caused a fast decline of flora and fauna:

- **Habitat loss:** forests are cleared for farming, mining, industries, roads, dams and towns.
- **Hunting and poaching** for trade in skins, bones, tusks, e.g. tigers were nearly wiped out.
- **Pollution** of air, water and soil, and over-use of resources by a growing population, harm plants and animals (e.g. gharials and birds in dirty rivers).

4 (i) **Describe how communities have conserved and protected forests and wildlife in India?**

✔ ANSWER

In India, forests are home to many traditional communities, and they have long worked to protect them.

1. **Sariska Tiger Reserve (Rajasthan):** villagers fought against mining by citing the Wildlife Protection Act.

2. **Bhairodev Dakav 'Sonchuri':** people of five villages in Alwar district (Rajasthan) declared 1,200 hectares of forest as a sanctuary with their own rules – no hunting and no outside encroachment.

3. **Chipko movement (Himalayas):** people resisted the cutting of trees and showed that community afforestation with local species can be very successful.

4. **Beej Bachao Andolan (Tehri) and Navdanya:** farmers showed that diverse crops can be grown without synthetic chemicals and still be profitable.

5. **Joint Forest Management (JFM):** since 1988 (first in Odisha), village institutions protect degraded forest land and in return get non-timber forest produce and a share of timber.

6. **Sacred groves and nature worship:** some forests are left untouched for gods; tribals worship mahua, kadamba, tamarind and mango trees; Bishnois protect blackbuck, nilgai and peacocks.

Thus, local communities play a key role, and they should be at the centre of decision-making in natural resource management.

4 (ii) **Write a note on good practices towards conserving forest and wildlife.**

✔ ANSWER

Conservation is essential because forests and wildlife preserve our life support systems – air, water and soil – and genetic diversity.

1. **Laws:** The Indian Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972 banned hunting, gave legal protection to habitats and restricted trade in wildlife.

2. **Protected areas:** National parks, wildlife sanctuaries and tiger reserves have been set up (e.g. Corbett, Sunderbans, Periyar).

3. **Special projects:** Project Tiger (1973) and projects for the one-horned rhino, hangul, crocodiles, Asiatic lion, etc.

4. **Wider protection:** insects (butterflies, moths, beetles, a dragonfly) and, since 1991, plants have been added to the list of protected species.

5. **Community efforts:** Chipko movement, Joint Forest Management, Beej Bachao Andolan, sacred groves and the Bishnoi tradition.

6. **Individual efforts:** planting trees, saving paper, avoiding plastic and not buying products made from wild animals.

Only people-centric, environment-friendly development, with everyone's participation, can save our forests and wildlife.

🎉 **Chapter 2 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**